SINGAPORE UNIVERSITY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES

MKT202

Proctored Online Exam - January Semester 2026

Marketing Management

Wednesday, 15 April 2026 **10:00 am - 12:00 pm**

Time allowed: 2 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO STUDENTS:

1. This examination contains **2** questions.
2. Answer all parts of each question in the corresponding answer box.
3. You must answer ALL questions.
4. All answers must be typed in the answer box and submitted in Examena.
5. This is an **Open-book** examination.
6. To prevent plagiarism and collusion, your submission will be reviewed by Turnitin. The Turnitin report will only be made available to the marker and you will not be able to view it.
7. The University takes plagiarism and collusion seriously, and your Turnitin report will be examined thoroughly as part of the marking process.

At the end of the examination.
To end the examination, please click on the "Submit and end exam" button to submit your answers.

THE UNIVERSITY RESERVES THE RIGHT NOT TO MARK YOUR SCRIPT IF YOU FAIL TO FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS.

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(Full marks: 100)

Section A (100 marks)
Answer all questions in this section.

Question 1

Amid S'pore's tough food scene, this vending biz has 120+ machines & offers a new F&B alternative

InstaChef, a brand by food tech company Aikit Pte Ltd, claims it can deliver fresh, restaurant-style meals straight from its vending machines by combining AI, automation and culinary know-how. The company now operates over 120 units across Singapore, located in office buildings, residential areas, and schools, including NUS.

InstaChef's Marketing Manager, Crono Lee, explains how the company backs up its promise of high-quality meals anytime, anywhere. Founded in 2021, Aikit spent two years investing heavily in R&D, including vending technology and data-driven automation, before launching its first InstaChef vending machine in Aug 2023.

What sets InstaChef apart is how its meals are prepared. Unlike pre-cooked dishes that are simply reheated, often leaving food dry or overcooked, InstaChef's offerings are par-cooked and finished on-demand inside the unit. Meals are completed using either induction or microwave heating. Induction takes five to 10 minutes, replicating freshly prepared food. This method preserves both texture and nutritional value, similar to restaurants while microwave heating takes two to three minutes, for those in a hurry.

Main dishes are priced between S$5 and S$9. Customers can place orders directly on-site or through the InstaChef app, which also allows them to track the cooking process and receive a notification when their meal is ready for collection. Customers can add canned drinks or desserts, and the meal emerges from a heated locker system, neatly placed in a recyclable paper bag.

Once stocks run low, its proprietary AI-powered software, ChefGenie, automatically alerts the central kitchen to prepare and pack more food for chilled delivery. Hygiene is a top priority for InstaChef. Units are cleaned whenever they are restocked, at least once every two days, and up to three times daily in high traffic areas. AI analytics is used to determine restocking schedules and monitor unit performance. The same system also customises menus by location to curb food waste: schools skew toward Western items, while office clusters favour Asian dishes.

Across Singapore, its vending machines offer more than 80 dishes, with each unit carrying about 15 top selections tailored to local demand and rotated every two to three months. Variety is central to the brand's strategy, helping it stand out in a market dominated by hot-food vending operators. What surprises customers is the taste and variety of dishes they offer. The brand is constantly developing new recipes to keep

menus fresh and customers returning.

In 2024, InstaChef launched a franchising programme, which has seen a positive response. Growth has been "strong and steady," with InstaChef's franchise network expanding month-on-month. Today, over 30% of its deployed machines are operated by franchise partners. Aikit handles all backend operations and management, allowing franchisees to focus on securing strategic locations that will drive business growth.

AiKit's vice-president for business and operations Sky Goh, 48, is looking to double the number of machines in Singapore, and is poised to take on the world. So far, AiKit has launched in the United States, with locations at California tertiary institutions including Saddleback College and California State University, Long Beach.

(adapted for academic purposes from: https://vulcanpost.com/899197/instachef-hot-meal-vending-machines/ and https://www.straitstimes.com/life/food/now-dispensing-new-vending-machines-bank-on-fresh-brews-bakes-and-meals)

Question 1a

Discuss a total of ***two (2)*** trends from economic, sociocultural or technological environmental factors (select *ONLY two factors* from the given three macroenvironmental factors) that has spurred the growth of hot-food vending machines in Singapore.

(16 marks)

Question 1b

Identify ***one (1)*** pricing method that was implemented by InstaChef for its hot-food vending machines and examine ***one (1)*** **other** pricing strategy that could be adopted by the company.

(12 marks)

Question 1c

Appraise the reasons why InstaChef adopted franchising as its channel strategy in Singapore and analyse whether it would use the same strategy when expanding into overseas markets like United States and Australia.

(14 marks)

Question 2

Sweat, plunge, soak, repeat: How recovery spaces are changing Singapore's wellness scene

The first time Ms Amy Tan tried a cold plunge in Singapore, she lasted just 30 seconds in the 8 degrees celsius pool before leaping out. "I couldn't feel my feet," she says of

her first visit to The Ice Bath Club in River Valley in May. Her second dip was twice as long at one minute and she lasted six minutes on her third try.

She grew to love the ritual of using a sauna, cold plunge and hot magnesium salt bath so much that she visits the Duxton branch five times a week after teaching classes. Ms Tan likens the experience to having her "body, mind and soul reset" and has stopped buying packages at traditional Chinese massage centres. She says that her nagging neck and shoulder pains have all gone away.

While contrast therapy – such as saunas followed by cold plunges – can be traced back to ancient times and elite athletes have long used ice baths for recovery, a new breed of recovery spaces is hoping to make such treatments a way of life here and tap the US$1.8 trillion (S$2.3 trillion) global consumer wellness industry.

At least 10 venues focusing purely on recovery have sprung up in Singapore over the last two years or so with a diverse range of offerings, from those that offer more performance- or health-focused modalities to those that are more spa-like. Some have long opening hours, from as early as 7am to as late as 10pm.

People are now searching for ways to alleviate stress and enhance recovery, not just from workouts but also modern life, says Associate Professor Emily Ortega, dean of the School of Humanities and Behavioural Sciences at SUSS. "The mindset effect is also at play here – if you believe it will work for you, this mindset can influence our physiological symptoms and performance," adds Prof Ortega.

One of the most aggressively expanding brands is The Ice Bath Club, which opened three branches here in 18 months and now serves 12,000 customers monthly. Three more Singapore branches are on the cards. About a third of its customers drop in daily, and another third visit two to three times a week. The average Ice Bath Club member is aged 35 and there is a 60:40 male-female split among its clientele, with half of its customers Singaporean and the rest are expatriates.

Co-founder Andrew Collins says The Ice Bath Club is designed to provide a frictionless experience, from allowing drop-ins to providing swimsuits, towels, electrolyte drinks and lockers as part of the price. All its branches include cafes where customers can grab a healthy bite and chill or work. Weekday off-peak prices start at $39 with no time limit, and a 14-day unlimited access trial costs $180.

While The Ice Bath Club sports an upbeat and cheerful vibe, Shelter by ReFormd at One Raffles Link, on the other hand, feels more like stepping into a cocoon. The scent of essential oils from Aesop greets customers as they enter. Sunlight filtering through a glass brick wall and indirect cove lights give an intimate feel to the 3,000 sq ft recovery space, which opened recently. It holds three cold immersion pools, a large warm salt pool, a dry sauna and a compression therapy lounge for tired muscles.

Membership starts at $65 a week for unlimited access (with a two-week commitment) and customers can buy credit packs starting from $450 for 10 sessions. Bathing suits,

designer towels, electrolytes and water are included in the fees. Shelter is a step towards the ReFormd Group's vision of an end-to-end fitness, recovery and wellness ecosystem, says founder Ari Gani, an Indonesian in his 30s who was born and raised in Singapore.

"Shelter was created mainly for athletes and office professionals who push themselves daily, whether in training or at work," Mr Gani says, adding that cold immersion sharpens alertness and focus for working adults, while the magnesium-infused pool helps them sleep better. A second outlet is due to open in Tiong Bahru in the first quarter of 2026.

"The global fitness landscape has evolved rapidly, fuelled by the rise of strength training, group run clubs, Hyrox and pickleball. As people move more, they're also learning the value of slowing down," he adds.

(Adapted for academic purposes from: https://www.straitstimes.com/life/sweat-plunge-soak-repeat-how-recovery-spaces-are-changing-singapores-wellness-scene)

Question 2a

Explain the needs, wants and demands for consumers using or purchasing services at the recovery clubs mentioned in the case study.

(15 marks)

Question 2b

There are four characteristics of services marketing, namely *intangibility, inseparability, variability, and perishability*. Based on your understanding of the case, select ***two (2)*** of these four characteristics of services that you feel are most relevant to the Ice Bath Club and infer the strategies that the club has used to mitigate the challenges of the selected ***two (2)*** characteristics.

(15 marks)

Question 2c

Discuss ***one (1)*** **social factor** and ***one (1) personal factor*** that could influence a consumer to visit and/or purchase membership at any of the recovery clubs cited in the case study.

(12 marks)

Question 2d

Propose a marketing communication campaign for The Ice Bath Club or Shelter by ReFormed with *building awareness* ***or*** *building preferences* as its communication objective by employing ***two (2)*** digital communication tools to encourage more

customers to purchase their services.

You should select the most suitable and effective digital tools / formats among the following: online communication, social media, mobile communication, and word-of-mouth.

(16 marks)

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